PawFect Parents: player decision tree

Every action a player can take in Levels 1 and 2, what the game says or shows in reply, and the learning objective each reply serves. The dog is called Biscuit here; in the game it is the name the player chose. Built from the game's own text, so it matches what players see. Level 3 is not built yet and is not included.

Scene or cutscene · Decision point · Player action · Good outcome · Wrong outcome · Information / neutral · Game rule (dashed) · Click a box with a + or – to open or close its branches.

How a play-through flows

Click a step to jump to its decision tree. Each tree reads from left to right: a decision point, what the player can do, and what the game says back, with the learning objective (LO) each answer serves.

1 **Title and dog setup**
Name and colour the dog
CTX

2 **Opening cutscene**
The parent explains the jobs
CTX LO1 LO2

3 **Level 1, Task 1: Snack Time**
Safe or unsafe food, 3 rounds
LO1

4 **Level 1, Task 2: Potty Training**
Place the pad, lead, reward
LO2 LO3

5 **Album and growth**
Puppy becomes a young dog
LO1 LO2

6 **Level 2, Task 1: Help the Vet**
Four checks build the list
LO4

7 **Level 2, Task 2: Pet Store Run**
Needs, wants and a budget
LO5 LO4

8 **Album and growth**
Young dog becomes an adult
LO4 LO5

9 **Rules in every task**
Meter, hints, retry, pause

Generated 2026-11-04 by tools/decision_tree/build.mjs from src/content.js (128 boxes). Learning objectives are defined in GAME_DESIGN.md section 1.2. Meter changes are in points on a 0 to 100 scale.

Start: dog setup and the opening cutscene CTX LO1 LO2

The player names and chooses their dog before anything is taught, so that they care what happens to it. Then a four-panel story sets up the first two skills.

DECISION **Dog setup screen**

A puppy wagging on a rug, three coat swatches, a name field with an on-screen keyboard (a real keyboard works too), a Random button and Adopt!.

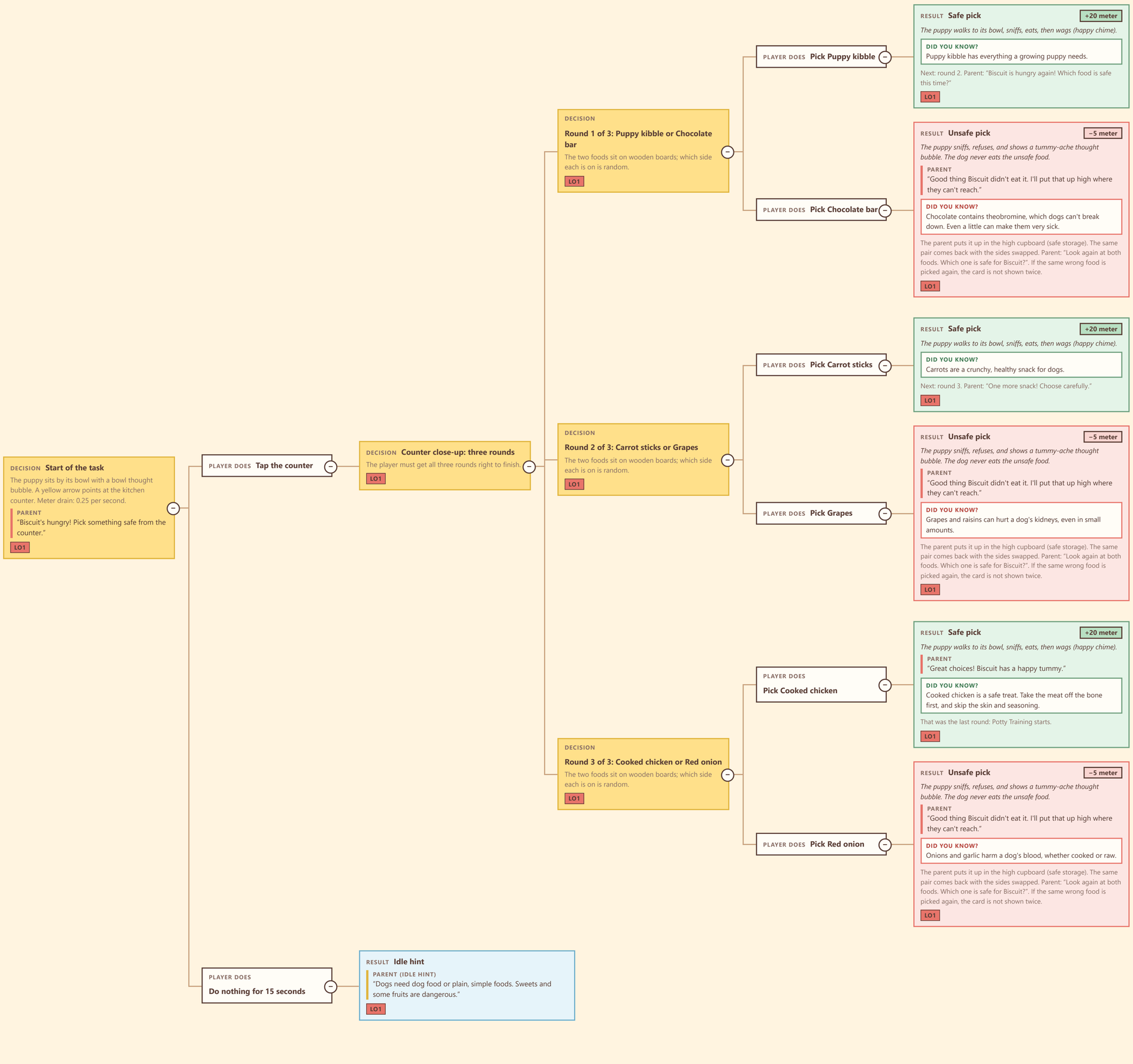
CTX

- **PLAYER DOES** **Tap a coat swatch (cream, caramel or chocolate)**
  - **RESULT** **The puppy changes colour**
    The puppy wags in the new coat and a wag sound plays. The whole game uses this coat.
    CTX
- **PLAYER DOES** **Type a name (up to 10 letters)**
  - **RESULT** **The name appears**
    The first key replaces the suggested name. The first letter is a capital, the rest are lowercase.
    CTX
- **PLAYER DOES** **Tap Random**
  - **RESULT** **A random name**
    One of 10: Biscuit, Mochi, Pepper, Noodle, Waffles, Bean, Pip, Toffee, Maple, Scout.
    CTX
- **PLAYER DOES** **Tap Adopt!**
  - **SCENE**
    Opening cutscene (4 panels, tap to continue, Skip is available)
    - **PARENT** “We're bringing home a new puppy today!”
    - **PARENT** “Welcome home, Biscuit! Everything smells new.”
    - **PARENT** “Taking care of Biscuit is your job now. Don't worry, I'll help at first.”
    - **PARENT** “Puppies need the right food, and they need to learn where to go potty. Let's start there!”

    Panels: the drive home, arriving at the porch, the PUPPY JOBS chart on the fridge, and the puppy's new things. If the name is empty, a random name is used. Level 1 starts next.
    CTX LO1 LO2

Level 1, Task 1: Snack Time LO1

Good food or bad food. Three rounds, each a safe food against an unsafe one. A right pick is rewarded and explained; a wrong pick is a gentle nudge with a safety fact, never a punishment.



Level 1, Task 2: Potty Training LO2 LO3

Place the pad, then read the puppy's signs and lead it with a treat, and reward it right away. This is where positive reinforcement is taught, and where scolding is shown not to work.

DECISION **Part A: place the pad**

Three yellow arrows point at the possible spots. The pad can be dragged.

PARENT
"Where should Biscuit's potty pad go? Drag it to a good spot."

LO2

- **PLAYER DOES** **Drop the pad next to the food bowl**
  - **RESULT** **Poor spot** — −5 meter
    - DID YOU KNOW? Dogs don't like to go potty near where they eat.
    - The pad slides back and the player tries again. If the same wrong spot is chosen again, the card is not repeated.
    - LO2
- **PLAYER DOES** **Drop the pad the middle of the room (the rug)**
  - **RESULT** **Poor spot** — −5 meter
    - DID YOU KNOW? The middle of the room is busy and stressful, so the puppy may avoid it.
    - The pad slides back and the player tries again. If the same wrong spot is chosen again, the card is not repeated.
    - LO2
- **PLAYER DOES** **Drop the pad the quiet corner by the garden door**
  - **RESULT** **Best spot** — +20 meter
    - DID YOU KNOW? A quiet corner by the door makes it easier to move to outdoor potty later.
    - Part B starts.
    - LO2
- **PLAYER DOES** **Drop the pad away from all three spots**
  - **RESULT** **Pad slides back**
    - No message and no change to the meter.
- **PLAYER DOES** **Do nothing for 15 seconds**
  - **RESULT** **Idle hint**
    - PARENT (IDLE HINT) "Dogs like a quiet potty spot, away from where they eat and sleep."
    - LO2

DECISION

Part B: read the signs and lead the puppy (two successes needed)

The puppy wanders for a few seconds, then sniffs the floor and circles. A thought bubble shows a droplet. The treat sits on the counter.

PARENT
"Now watch Biscuit closely. They'll show you when they need to go!"

LO2 LO3

DECISION

The puppy sniffs and circles (12 second window)

The explanation appears the moment the signs start, whatever the player is doing. A yellow arrow points at the treat.

PARENT
"Biscuit is sniffing and circling. That means "I need to go!" Drag the treat from the counter to lead them to the pad."

PARENT, SECOND TIME
"Biscuit is sniffing again! Lead them to the pad."

LO2

- **PLAYER DOES** **Drag the treat and keep holding it so the puppy follows it onto the pad**
  - **RESULT** **The puppy goes potty on the pad**
    - *It follows the treat, reaches the pad, pees for a moment, then wags with a treat thought bubble.*
    - PARENT "Biscuit went on the pad! Reward them right away: drop the treat on Biscuit."
    - LO2
    - **DECISION** **Reward right away**
      - A yellow arrow points at the puppy.
      - LO3
      - **PLAYER DOES** **Drop the treat on the puppy**
        - **RESULT** **Reward given** — +20 meter
          - *The puppy eats, wags, and a heart floats up.*
          - GREAT JOB! That's positive reinforcement! Rewarding good behavior right away is a great way to train a dog. Biscuit learns that using the pad means good things happen.
          - The card is shown the first time only. The second time the parent says: "Biscuit did it again, and you rewarded them right away. That's how puppies learn!"
          - LO3
      - **PLAYER DOES** **Wait 15 seconds**
        - **RESULT** **Idle hint**
          - PARENT (IDLE HINT) "Biscuit went on the pad! Reward them right away: drop the treat on Biscuit."
          - LO3
- **PLAYER DOES** **Let go of the treat too early**
  - **RESULT** **The treat jumps back to the counter**
    - *The puppy keeps circling and waits.*
    - No message. The 12 second timer keeps running.
    - LO2
- **PLAYER DOES** **Do nothing for 15 seconds**
  - **RESULT** **Idle hint**
    - PARENT (IDLE HINT) "Keep holding the treat, and walk slowly so Biscuit keeps following it."
    - LO2
- **PLAYER DOES** **Run out of time (12 seconds), or never reach the pad**
  - **RESULT** **An accident on the floor**
    - *The puppy pees on the floor and a small puddle appears.*
    - PARENT "Oops, an accident on the floor. What do you do?"
    - LO3
    - **PLAYER DOES** **Scold the puppy**
      - **RESULT** **Scolded** — −5 meter
        - *The puppy cowers.*
        - DID YOU KNOW? Scolding teaches puppies to hide when they go, not where to go.
        - The sniffing and circling starts again.
        - LO3
    - **PLAYER DOES** **Clean it up calmly**
      - **RESULT** **Calm clean-up** — +10 meter
        - *The puddle fades away.*
        - DID YOU KNOW? Clean accidents well. Leftover smell makes a puppy go there again.
        - The sniffing and circling starts again.
        - LO3

RESULT **Task complete (two successes)**

PARENT
"Biscuit is learning fast!"

DID YOU KNOW? Puppies often need to go after waking up, eating, and playing.

The meter fills and the Day 1 album page appears.

LO2

Album pages and growth cutscenes LO1 LO2 LO4 LO5

After each level the player sees what they learned on a photo-album page, then the dog grows up. A “Pawfect!” stamp appears when the whole level had no wrong answer.

SCENE **After Level 1: album page “Day 1”**

You learned: Safe foods and Potty spot.

The skills are ticked one at a time. No wrong answers in the whole level gives the Pawfect! stamp; otherwise it says how many slips there were and that this is how we learn.

LO1 LO2

SCENE **Growth cutscene: puppy to young dog**

PARENT
“Look how much Biscuit has grown! You're doing a great job.”

Leads to the Level 2 intro cutscene.

CTX

SCENE

After Level 2: album page “Check-up Day”

You learned: Health check and Smart shopping.

Same rules as Level 1.

LO4 LO5

SCENE **Growth cutscene: young dog to adult**

PARENT
“Look how big Biscuit is now! You're doing a great job.”

Then the end card: “Thanks for playing!”. Level 3 (the park) is not built yet.

CTX

Level 2, Task 1: Help the Vet LO4

Four health checks, in any order. Each finding is explained by the vet and becomes an item on the shopping list. The player can also calm the nervous dog.

SCENE **Level 2 intro cutscene**

PARENT
"Time for Biscuit's first check-up! Afterwards we'll buy whatever the vet says Biscuit needs."

The parent sets the plan: a check-up, then shopping for what the vet says is needed.

CTX LO4 LO5

DECISION **Start of the task**

A sky-blue clinic. The dog is on the exam table with its ears back and tail tucked. Four spots glow. Meter drain: 0.35 per second.

VET
"Let's check Biscuit from nose to tail. Tap each spot to look closer."

LO4

PLAYER DOES
Tap Teeth (the ring on the dog or the label)

RESULT **Close-up: teeth**

A magnifying-glass close-up opens. The meter is paused while it is open.

VET
"Yellow tartar on the teeth! Brushing a few times a week keeps teeth and gums healthy."

Dog toothbrush and Dog toothpaste fly onto the shopping list. The pointer arrow is only on this first spot.

LO4

PLAYER DOES
Tap Coat (the ring on the dog or the label)

RESULT **Close-up: coat**

A magnifying-glass close-up opens. The meter is paused while it is open.

VET
"A flea! Fleas cause itching and can spread illness, so monthly prevention helps."

Flea treatment (dog) fly onto the shopping list.

LO4

PLAYER DOES
Tap Paws (the ring on the dog or the label)

RESULT **Close-up: paws**

A magnifying-glass close-up opens. The meter is paused while it is open.

VET
"Long nails click on the floor. They hurt when walking, so trim them regularly."

Nail clippers fly onto the shopping list.

LO4

PLAYER DOES
Tap Ears (the ring on the dog or the label)

RESULT **Close-up: ears**

A magnifying-glass close-up opens. The meter is paused while it is open.

VET
"A little wax in the ears. A gentle ear cleaner helps, and checking every week keeps them healthy."

Ear cleaner (dog) fly onto the shopping list.

LO4

PLAYER DOES
Tap the dog (once between checks)

RESULT **A calming pat** +5 meter

The dog wags and a heart floats up.

VET
"Biscuit feels calmer. Good job!"

After the first check the vet reminds the player: "Biscuit is a little nervous. Tap Biscuit for a calming pat!". Only one pat counts per gap between checks. This introduces reading a dog's stress, which comes back in Level 3.

CTX

PLAYER DOES
Do nothing for 25 seconds

RESULT **Idle hint**

VET (IDLE HINT)
"Tap a glowing spot on Biscuit, or the label next to it. Teeth, coat, paws and ears all need a look."

LO4

PLAYER DOES
Finish all four checks

RESULT **Check-up complete**

VET
"That's everything! Biscuit was great. Next up: a vaccine."

The shopping list now has five items: Dog toothbrush, Dog toothpaste, Flea treatment (dog), Nail clippers and Ear cleaner (dog).

LO4

SCENE **Vaccine cutscene**

VET
"Biscuit was so brave! Vaccines protect against serious diseases, and only a vet can give them."

A vaccine is a story beat, not an item to buy: only a vet can give one.

LO4

Level 2, Task 2: Pet Store Run LO5 LO4

Shopping with a budget of 60 coins and a ticking meter. The nine needs cost 54 coins, so there is room for a want or two, but not for everything. Look-alike items test what the vet taught.

DECISION Start of the task

A lavender store with four aisles. Health: Dog toothbrush, Dog toothpaste, Human toothpaste, Flea treatment (dog), Flea treatment (cat), Ear cleaner (dog). Grooming: Nail clippers, Brush, Dog shampoo, Human shampoo. Play & Walk: Chew toy, Squeaky ball, Tiny ball, ID tag, Poop bags. Home & Style: Bandana, Bow, Sweater, Sparkly collar, Dog bed. The meter is paused during the parent's introduction. Meter drain: 0.35 per second.

PARENT
"Now let's go shopping for everything the vet said Biscuit needs!"

PARENT
"Also pick up a brush, an ID tag, a chew toy and poop bags. Here are 60 coins. Needs first, then extras!"

The parent writes four more lines on the paper list (Brush, ID tag, Chew toy, Poop bags) and hands over 60 coins. Tips from the parent hide after a few seconds so they never cover the shelves.

LO5

PLAYER DOES Tap an arrow

RESULT The shelves slide to the next aisle

Health, Grooming, Play & Walk, Home & Style, then round again.

PLAYER DOES
Tap an item on a shelf

DECISION
Item card: name, price, and the coins left after buying

LO5

PLAYER DOES Tap "Not now"

RESULT The card closes

Nothing changes.

PLAYER DOES
Tap "Add" on a vet need (Dog toothbrush, Dog toothpaste, Flea treatment (dog), Nail clippers, Ear cleaner (dog))

RESULT A need from the vet +10 meter

The item flies into the basket and its box on the paper list gets a tick.

The +10 is given once per item, so taking an item out and back in cannot be farmed. No card: the vet already explained why at the clinic.

LO5 LO4

PLAYER DOES
Tap "Add" on a need the parent added (Brush, ID tag, Chew toy, Poop bags)

RESULT A need from the parent +10 meter

The item flies into the basket and its box on the paper list gets a tick.

BRUSH: DID YOU KNOW?
Brushing keeps a dog's coat clean and tangle-free, and it spreads natural oils that make fur shiny.

ID TAG: DID YOU KNOW?
A tag with your phone number helps a lost dog get home fast.

CHEW TOY: DID YOU KNOW?
Chew toys give a dog something safe to chew. Pick one that is bigger than your dog's mouth, so it can't be swallowed.

POOP BAGS: DID YOU KNOW?
Picking up after your dog keeps parks clean and healthy for everyone.

One card per item, shown the first time that item is bought.

LO5

PLAYER DOES
Tap "Add" on a want (Dog shampoo, Squeaky ball, Bandana, Bow, Sweater, Sparkly collar, Dog bed)

RESULT A want, with enough coins left for the needs

The item goes in the basket. Wants are never wrong and give no points.

LOOKING GOOD!
Style is fine if it is comfortable, fits well, and the dog can still see and move freely.

The card is shown for the first want only.

LO5

RESULT A want that would leave too little for the needs −5 meter

The item flies to the basket and straight back to the shelf. Nothing is charged.

PARENT
"Needs first! Keep enough coins for everything on the list."

NEEDS COME FIRST!
If we buy that now, we won't have enough coins for everything on the list. Food, health and safety come before extras.

The card is shown once. After that the parent says the short line instead.

LO5

PLAYER DOES
Tap "Add" on a look-alike (Human toothpaste, Flea treatment (cat), Human shampoo, Tiny ball)

RESULT The wrong item −5 meter

The item flies to the basket and straight back to the shelf. Nothing is charged.

PARENT
"Check the label first. That one isn't made for dogs."

HUMAN TOOTHPASTE: LOOK AT THE LABEL!
Human toothpaste often has xylitol or fluoride, which are unsafe for dogs to swallow.

FLEA TREATMENT (CAT): LOOK AT THE LABEL!
Flea products are made for one species. Always match the label.

HUMAN SHAMPOO: LOOK AT THE LABEL!
A dog's skin is different from ours, so use a shampoo made for dogs.

TINY BALL: LOOK AT THE LABEL!
Toys that are small enough to swallow can make a dog choke. Choose one that is bigger than its mouth.

One card per item, shown once. After that the parent says the short line instead.

LO5 LO4

PLAYER DOES
Tap "Add" on something that costs more than the coins left

RESULT Not enough coins

PARENT
"That's more than we have left. Put something back in the basket first."

The card already warned "Not enough coins" in red.

LO5

PLAYER DOES
Tap an item in the basket

RESULT Put it back

The coins are refunded and the tick on the list is removed.

LO5

PLAYER DOES
Tap "Keep shopping"

RESULT The panel closes

PLAYER DOES Tap the basket

DECISION Basket panel

Everything bought so far, and the total.

LO5

PLAYER DOES Tap "Checkout"

DECISION Checkout

LO5 LO4

PLAYER DOES
Some needs are still not in the basket

RESULT Not yet

PARENT
"We're not done yet. Some things on the list still need a tick."

LO5

PLAYER DOES
All nine needs are in the basket

RESULT The till: each item is explained, one by one

Each item appears on the counter and the parent says why it was bought. A tap moves on.

PARENT
"The dog toothbrush is for the yellow tartar the vet found on Biscuit's teeth."

PARENT
"Dog toothpaste goes with it. Human toothpaste is not safe for dogs to swallow."

PARENT
"The flea treatment is for the flea the vet found on Biscuit's coat."

PARENT
"The nail clippers are for Biscuit's long nails."

PARENT
"The ear cleaner is for the wax the vet saw in Biscuit's ears."

PARENT
"A brush keeps Biscuit's coat clean and tangle-free."

PARENT
"An ID tag helps Biscuit get home if they ever get lost."

PARENT
"Biscuit needs something safe to chew."

PARENT
"Poop bags keep parks clean and healthy for everyone."

PARENT
"A little extra for Biscuit, bought with the leftover coins."

PARENT
"That's everything on the list, and we stayed within our coins. Great shopping!"

The "a little extra" line is only said for wants in the basket. The meter then fills and the "Check-up Day" album page appears.

LO5 LO4

PLAYER DOES
Put every need in the basket

RESULT Everything is on the list

PARENT
"That is everything on the list! Tap the basket to check out."

LO5

PLAYER DOES
Do nothing for 25 seconds

RESULT Idle hint

PARENT (IDLE HINT)
"Tap an item for its price. Use the arrows for more aisles, and the basket when you are done."

LO5

Rules that apply everywhere: meter, hints, retry and pause

LO1 LO2 LO3 LO4 LO5

The happiness meter is a soft timer and the feedback: right actions raise it, wrong actions only nudge it down. Help fades as the levels go on. Running out of meter never ends the game: the task restarts with a hint.

GAME RULE **Happiness meter**

Starts each task at 80 of 100. Drains 0.25 per second in Level 1 and 0.35 per second in Level 2. It is paused while a card, a close-up, a choice or the pause menu is open, so reading never costs anything. Green above 60, yellow from 30 to 60, red below 30.

PLAYER DOES
The meter reaches 0

RESULT **Retry screen**

The scene greys out, the sad dog lies in a spotlight, the parent explains what was needed, and a Try again button restarts that task only.

PARENT
"Biscuit got too hungry and sad. Remember: only dog-safe food. Let's try again!"

PARENT
"Biscuit needed help with potty time. Watch for sniffing and circling. Let's try again!"

PARENT
"Biscuit got too nervous. Gentle pats keep a dog calm, and a check-up goes best when you take your time. Let's try again!"

PARENT
"The shopping took too long, and Biscuit is waiting at home. Let's try again, and check the list first!"

In order: Snack Time, Potty Training, Help the Vet, Pet Store Run. A retry shows the hint straight away, and facts already seen are not shown again.

LO1 LO2 LO4 LO5

PLAYER DOES
The player waits without progress

RESULT **Idle hints**

LEVEL 1, AFTER 15 S (IDLE HINT)
"Dogs need dog food or plain, simple foods. Sweets and some fruits are dangerous."

LEVEL 1, AFTER 15 S (IDLE HINT)
"Dogs like a quiet potty spot, away from where they eat and sleep."

LEVEL 1, AFTER 15 S (IDLE HINT)
"Keep holding the treat, and walk slowly so Biscuit keeps following it."

LEVEL 2, AFTER 25 S (IDLE HINT)
"Tap a glowing spot on Biscuit, or the label next to it. Teeth, coat, paws and ears all need a look."

LEVEL 2, AFTER 25 S (IDLE HINT)
"Tap an item for its price. Use the arrows for more aisles, and the basket when you are done."

Level 1 shows pointer arrows on what matters. Level 2 has only one arrow, on the first spot at the vet. The hint timer restarts after every action and does not run while the meter is paused.

LO1 LO2 LO3 LO4 LO5

PLAYER DOES
The player taps the pause button

DECISION **Pause menu**

PLAYER DOES **Resume**

RESULT **Back to the task**

Everything is frozen while paused, including the meter and timers.

PLAYER DOES **Sound on or off**

RESULT **The sound is toggled**

PLAYER DOES **Quit to title**

RESULT **Back to the title screen**

Progress in the current task is lost.